- Reduced bladder sensitivity to over distention
- Increased coagulability
- Fall in plasma volume

### Uterine Involution

- In pregnancy, uterus increases 11 times in size and weight.
- Rapid involution – immediately following delivery it reduces from 1000gm to 100gm at the end of 6 weeks.
- Reversal of hypertrophy due to withdrawal of sex hormone causes increases collagenase, proteolytic enzyme causes autolysis of intracellular protein.
- Decrease uterine volume due to increase myometrial force and intrauterine pressure 150 mmHg.
- After pains 2 – 3 days more in multiparous and more during lactation due to increase in oxytocin.
- Uterine cavity- sterile, bactericidal effects of granulation tissues.

### Lochia

Lochia is the vaginal discharge after giving birth.

*Rubra*– last for 3 days, contains fresh blood and necrotic tissue.

*Serosa* – last for 4-9 days, contains liquefied blood, leucocytes, serous, palour and reddish brown in colour.

*Alba* – last for 10-15 days ,contains leucocytes, mucus decidual cells, yellowish white in colour.

### Cervix

- 1ST week – closes to 1 cm.
- External os – transverse slit.
- Complete healing 6 – 12 weeks.

### Vagina

- Smooth, swollen and poor tone after delivery.
- 3 weeks – rugae first appear.
- 6 – 10 weeks – epithelium restored to normal.
- Lower vagina – suffers superficial laceration.

### Pelvic Floor

Normal by 6 weeks except varying degree of musculoskeletal laceration.

### Urinary Tract

- Immediate postpartum – bladder mucosabecomes edematous
- Over distension – incomplete emptying and presence of , residual urine are common urinary problem in puerperium
- 1 – 2 days – mild proteinuria in 50 % of women
- By 8 weeks – renal plasma flow reduces to normal, glomerular filteration returns to normal.
- Creatinine clearance becomes normal by 1st week.

### Fluids And Electrolytes

- Weight loss - immediately after delivery – 5.5 kg – fetus, placenta, amniotic fluid 4 kg – excretion of fluids and electrolytes.
- Fluid loss – 2 liltres during 1st week. – 1.5 litres – next 5 weeks.

### Electrolytes

- Total exchangeable sodium decreased but body water loss exceeds sodium loss.
- Decreased plasma progesterone causes decreased aldosterone antagonism and increased sodium.
- Tissue involution – cellular breakdown, increases potassium level.

### Cardio Vascular Changes

i. Blood coagulation:
   - Rapid and dramatic changes in the coagulation and fibrinolytic system after delivery.



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